

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Software Quality Assurance and Testing English



Teacher's guide

Teach practical workplace communication with specific cases, clear language targets, and a repeatable feedback process.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Software quality assurance analysts, manual testers, test engineers, automation engineers, and test leads.

All products, builds, test data, results, and incidents are fictional English-language practice, not a testing certification course, security assessment, implementation manual, or release authorization. Quality assurance includes broader quality practices; these lessons focus on testing communication within those roles. Use the actual product contract, tools, evidence, qualified reviewers, and local decision responsibilities in real work. No specific platform behavior or universal defect-rating scheme is implied.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Agreeing the expected result

Resolve a missing expectation before assigning a test verdict.

02 Making a failure reproducible

Supply the starting state, actions, and result needed to repeat an observation.

03 Choosing cases at boundaries and across rules

Justify a small test selection using the rule's actual distinctions.

04 Explaining coverage and change risk

Explain why broad initial checks do not replace targeted regression evidence.

05 Investigating inconsistent automated results

Use run context to distinguish a supported test problem from an unsupported product verdict.

06 Separating impact from scheduling in triage

Lead a defect discussion that separates impact, urgency, and decision ownership.

07 Reporting exploratory findings

Give a useful exploratory update naming the charter, evidence, and unanswered questions.

08 Giving a release-evidence handover

Hand over accurate test status and remaining uncertainty to the named decision owner.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

A 60-minute lesson that works

Prepare the case and the learner pages. Keep the model response hidden until learners have attempted their own. Choose two field terms that are important to understanding the case.

0-5 minutes | Activate experience

Ask learners to name a comparable situation without sharing confidential details. Introduce the communication goal.

5-12 minutes | Read and sort facts

Read the case. Learners identify confirmed facts, unknowns, the audience, and the immediate communication need.

12-22 minutes | Notice and practice language

Explain the workshop pattern. Work through the vocabulary and editing example, then discuss both language checks and the reasons behind the choices.

22-35 minutes | 05 • Conversations

Read one ten-turn conversation aloud, notice a useful expression, then compare the other two. Identify each speaker's purpose and how the exchange ends.

35-47 minutes | 06 • Say it

Rehearse both speaking scenarios from the workbook. Give two minutes of preparation, switch roles, and use the success checks. Add the complication only after a successful first round.

47-55 minutes | Compare and revise

Reveal the model. Discuss alternative acceptable wording. Give one meaning correction and one language correction, then repeat.

55-60 minutes | Retrieve and transfer

Close the materials. Learners recall two expressions and identify one communication habit to use in another situation.

Adapt the session

For 45 minutes, study one complete conversation and rehearse one scenario; assign the others for oral follow-up. For 90 minutes, rehearse all three conversations and give both scenarios a second round. More time should produce more meaningful practice, not longer explanations.

LESSON 01 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Agreeing the expected result

Resolve a missing expectation before assigning a test verdict.

CASE

A fictional booking feature says cancellations are allowed 'within 24 hours.' One example allows cancellation exactly 24 hours before the event; another rejects it. Time-zone handling is outside this exercise. The requirement owner can clarify the equality case.

Teach this move

A test oracle is the basis for judging the result, not necessarily another program. When wording and examples conflict, state the precise input whose outcome is uncertain and ask the responsible person to settle it.

Vocabulary to check: test oracle, acceptance criterion, expected result, ambiguity.

Model response

The phrase within twenty-four hours leaves the boundary unclear, and the two examples disagree at exactly twenty-four hours before the event. Which outcome is intended at equality? I need an agreed acceptance criterion to judge that case. Until then, I can report the observed result, but I cannot assign a defensible pass or fail against these conflicting examples.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision distinguishes personal expectation from an agreed basis for evaluating the behavior.

Second-round challenge

Someone says the current implementation should define correctness automatically. Explain why reproducing existing behavior does not settle conflicting requirements.

Language-check answers

1. A - boundary Correct. Equality at the stated limit is the boundary question.
2. D - expected result Correct. Conflicting examples leave the intended outcome unresolved.

05 · Conversations

1. Exactly twenty-four hours before the event - A fictional tester and requirement owner clarify conflicting cancellation examples.
2. The old screen is not automatically the rule - A fictional tester challenges a reference screenshot used as the only expectation.
3. A reference calculator disagrees with the specification - Fictional testers compare two sources for a rounded display value.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | The warning text says soon

A fictional storage screen warns that a file will expire 'soon.' One acceptance example expects three days remaining; another expects seven. The requirement owner can choose three days for the warning boundary in this exercise.

Role A: Tester: request a measurable warning condition rather than inventing a meaning for soon.

Role B: Requirement owner: confirm three days remaining as the intended warning point and identify the seven-day example as outdated.

Possible opening: Which remaining-time condition should trigger this warning: three days or seven?

Success checks

- Identify the conflicting examples.
- Confirm the three-day criterion explicitly.
- Separate outdated evidence from the current expectation.

Add a complication: A colleague says either is acceptable because soon is subjective.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 02 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Making a failure reproducible

Supply the starting state, actions, and result needed to repeat an observation.

CASE

A fictional tester sees an export omit the last selected item in build Q12, using a saved selection of three items. A developer's one-item attempt succeeds. The tester reproduced the omission twice in two attempts; no other build or selection size has been checked.

Teach this move

A clear report distinguishes preconditions from steps and actual behavior from expected behavior. Two failures in two attempts are a bounded observation, not a claim that every user always fails.

Vocabulary to check: precondition, reproduction steps, test environment, actual result.

Model response

Could you repeat the export on Q12 with the saved three-item selection, rather than a new one-item selection? The last selected item was omitted in both recorded attempts. Those starting conditions differ from your passing attempt. I can provide the saved selection and action order; we have not established behavior for other builds or selection sizes.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised request gives a repeatable context and limits the frequency claim to the evidence.

Second-round challenge

A screenshot shows missing output but not the starting selection. Explain which reproduction detail still needs to accompany it.

Language-check answers

1. D - the saved three-item selection Correct. This matches the supplied failing selection.
2. C - in both recorded attempts Correct. This reports the two observed attempts without generalizing.

05 · Conversations

1. Three selected items, not one - A fictional tester requests a comparable reproduction of the Q12 export omission.
2. The report omitted the starting account state - A fictional tester and developer clarify why a saved filter isn't visible.
3. Observed twice is not observed everywhere - A fictional tester qualifies reproduction frequency during a defect discussion.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A video skips the action that matters

A fictional failure video begins after a user changes a sort order. The bug appears only after switching from newest-first to oldest-first; the report's written steps omit that switch. The build is S3.

Role A: Tester: identify and supply the missing sort action.

Role B: Developer: explain that opening the page directly in oldest-first does not reproduce the same sequence.

Possible opening: The video starts after the sort changed; the report needs that transition as a step.

Success checks

- State both the original and final sort modes.
- Preserve the action order and S3 build.
- Distinguish final state from the path that reached it.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests using the final screenshot as the complete reproduction.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 03 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Choosing cases at boundaries and across rules

Justify a small test selection using the rule's actual distinctions.

CASE

A fictional form accepts whole-number quantities from 1 through 20 inclusive and rejects values outside that range. A proposed test set contains 5, 10, and 15 only. Decimal handling is unspecified and outside the stated whole-number rule.

Teach this move

Partitioning groups inputs expected to receive similar treatment. Boundary cases probe transitions between groups. Neither approach means one successful sample proves every value behaves correctly; explain the selection and its limits.

Vocabulary to check: equivalence partition, boundary value, decision table, negative test.

Model response

Five, ten, and fifteen all sample the accepted interior. They do not check the limits or their neighboring rejected values. For the stated whole-number rule, zero, one, twenty, and twenty-one would examine both boundaries. Decimal handling is a separate unresolved rule; we should not assign its expected result by extending the whole-number requirement.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised statement describes the kind of coverage rather than substituting a test count for it.

Second-round challenge

A teammate offers negative one hundred as the only rejected case. Explain why near-boundary rejected values address a different risk.

Language-check answers

1. C - Twenty-one Correct. Twenty-one is the next whole number above the limit.
2. B - unspecified Correct. The supplied rule does not settle decimal inputs.

05 · Conversations

1. Three middle values miss both limits - A fictional tester explains a quantity-validation selection.
2. A partition is a reasoned group, not a random sample - Fictional testers explain an input grouping for a document type field.
3. A rule depends on two conditions - Fictional testers use a decision table to clarify permission examples.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A maximum label length needs units

A fictional field allows a maximum length of ten, but the requirement does not say bytes, displayed symbols, or another counting unit. A plain-letter example has ten characters and passes. Non-ASCII examples are not specified.

Role A: Tester: ask which counting unit defines the boundary.

Role B: Requirement owner: acknowledge the missing unit and request clarification from the interface owner before assigning other expected results.

Possible opening: Ten of what is the limit: which counting unit does the contract use?

Success checks

- Identify the unspecified counting unit.
- Keep the successful example's scope narrow.
- Avoid inventing a language-specific counting rule.

Add a complication: Someone treats one successful plain-letter example as proof for all scripts and symbols.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 04 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Explaining coverage and change risk

Explain why broad initial checks do not replace targeted regression evidence.

CASE

A fictional account update passes a smoke test covering sign-in and opening the account page. The update changes a formatter used by both account-save and the existing export path; neither path has been tested. One hour is available for further checking; no claim of full coverage is justified.

Teach this move

Coverage needs a named basis, such as requirements, paths, or configurations. A large test count does not establish that the changed behavior was checked. Describe the selection's rationale and the work left outside it.

Vocabulary to check: test coverage, traceability, regression testing, smoke test.

Model response

The smoke test shows that sign-in and page opening work in this build. It does not exercise save or export, both of which use the changed formatter. With one hour, I would prioritize those two paths over repeating page opening. That is a risk-based selection, not a claim that the entire account area has been tested.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision attaches the passing result to the behaviors actually checked.

Second-round challenge

A stakeholder calls requirement linkage proof of successful execution. Distinguish a mapped test from a test actually run with a result.

Language-check answers

1. B - shared formatter Correct. The common formatter connects the changed and existing paths.
2. A - what behaviors those tests exercise Correct. Coverage requires a stated basis, not just a count.

05 · Conversations

1. The smoke check missed the changed path - A fictional test lead and tester choose targeted checks within one hour.
2. Linked does not mean executed - Fictional colleagues distinguish a test's requirement mapping from its execution status.
3. A high percentage with the wrong denominator - Fictional testers clarify a coverage claim about account requirements.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A shared formatter reaches an unexpected report

A fictional date formatter is changed for the calendar screen. A dependency map shows that the billing report also uses it. Calendar examples passed; billing output has not been checked. Forty minutes remain.

Role A: Tester: explain why a billing regression check is relevant despite no billing-screen change.

Role B: Lead: ask which billing requirement and fixture would make the proposed check focused.

Possible opening: The calendar change reaches a formatter used by billing, so the report is a relevant regression path.

Success checks

- Name the shared dependency.
- Propose a bounded billing-output check.
- Keep untested reports outside the passing claim.

Add a complication: A colleague says untouched screens never need checking.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 05 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Investigating inconsistent automated results

Use run context to distinguish a supported test problem from an unsupported product verdict.

CASE

In a fictional automated suite on build T8, a search check fails after a cleanup check but passes when run alone. The cleanup check removes a shared sample record that the search check expects. No code change occurs between these observations.

Teach this move

An inconsistent test result still deserves investigation. Passing on rerun doesn't erase the earlier evidence. Once a fixture interaction is identified, limit the conclusion to that interaction rather than treating all failures as noise.

Vocabulary to check: flaky test, test fixture, test isolation, false positive.

Model response

The search check passes alone but fails after cleanup on the same build. Cleanup removes the sample record that search expects, which supports a test-isolation explanation for these observations. We should preserve the failure and correct the shared starting-state assumption. This finding does not by itself establish that every search behavior in the product is correct.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision names the evidenced interaction instead of using flakiness as a dismissal.

Second-round challenge

A colleague proposes reporting only the final passing attempt. Explain why the sequence and initial failure belong in the evidence.

Language-check answers

1. A - removed Correct. Cleanup removes the record that search expects.
2. D - the test's starting context Correct. Running alone changes the relevant test context.

05 · Conversations

1. Cleanup removes the search fixture - A fictional tester and automation engineer explain the T8 suite result.
2. A locator fails after a harmless label update - Fictional testers distinguish a broken automated check from the product behavior it intended to examine.
3. The rerun used different data - Fictional testers challenge a flaky-test label when the inputs changed.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A delayed message and a fixed wait

A fictional automated check looks for a message after a fixed two-second wait. The requirement permits it within five seconds. One observed message appears after three seconds. The check's clock and observation are reliable for this exercise.

Role A: Tester: explain why the two-second check can report a false positive against the five-second requirement.

Role B: Automation engineer: distinguish that observed case from messages arriving after five seconds.

Possible opening: This message arrived in three seconds, inside the requirement but after the test's two-second check.

Success checks

- Compare the actual three seconds with the stated five-second limit.
- Identify the narrower test assumption.
- Preserve failures beyond the requirement as a separate possibility.

Add a complication: A colleague proposes calling every delayed message acceptable regardless of duration.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 06 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Separating impact from scheduling in triage

Lead a defect discussion that separates impact, urgency, and decision ownership.

CASE

A fictional export defect affects one monthly workflow and omits the final row. A visible heading typo affects every account page. Tomorrow's customer demonstration uses that page; no export is planned. The team must discuss impact and timing separately, without assuming either issue is already approved for release.

Teach this move

Severity describes impact; priority concerns the order or urgency of attention. A visible issue can be urgent without becoming more functionally damaging. Use the team's stated rating scheme rather than inventing universal labels.

Vocabulary to check: severity, priority, defect triage, duplicate report.

Model response

Let's separate the two decisions. The export defect loses a row in one workflow; the heading typo affects presentation on every account page. Tomorrow's demonstration may influence scheduling, but it does not make the typo's functional impact greater. Could we agree each issue's impact first, then state the reason for its repair priority and any release concern?

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision separates scheduling pressure from the nature of the defect's effect.

Second-round challenge

A teammate wants to close a second report as duplicate because its title matches. Ask for the affected build, steps, and linked evidence first.

Language-check answers

1. D - priority Correct. Priority addresses order and urgency of work.
2. C - does not establish Correct. Additional evidence is needed to establish duplication.

05 · Conversations

1. The demonstration changes urgency, not the omitted row - A fictional tester facilitates triage of an export defect and a heading typo.
2. Matching titles do not establish duplicates - A fictional tester requests evidence before merging two blank-screen reports.
3. A deferred defect is not a resolved defect - A fictional tester clarifies the status of a postponed display correction.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Rare does not automatically mean low impact

A fictional report mislabels one customer category in one of twenty recorded runs. The mislabeled output can mislead users of that report. The cause and wider frequency are unknown; the team's rating scheme has not been supplied.

Role A: Tester: present frequency and effect separately without inventing a severity label.

Role B: Triage lead: ask who uses the output and request more context before assigning the team's rating.

Possible opening: We observed the mislabel once in twenty runs; its effect and frequency need separate consideration.

Success checks

- State the bounded one-in-twenty observation.
- Describe the misleading output as the known impact.
- Leave formal rating and wider frequency for contextual review.

Add a complication: A colleague calls it harmless solely because it was observed rarely.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 07 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Reporting exploratory findings

Give a useful exploratory update naming the charter, evidence, and unanswered questions.

CASE

A fictional twenty-minute exploratory session has the charter 'investigate interrupted profile edits.' The tester finds that navigating away after a saved edit preserves the value; navigating away during an unsaved edit loses it without warning. Whether a warning is required is unspecified. Mobile behavior was not explored.

Teach this move

Exploratory testing combines learning and test design as the session develops. A timebox bounds effort, not coverage. Explain why a clue was followed and distinguish demonstrated failures from concerns whose expected behavior is unsettled.

Vocabulary to check: exploratory testing, test charter, timebox, heuristic.

Model response

In the twenty-minute interrupted-edit session, saved values survived navigation. Unsaved values were lost without a warning in the desktop path I explored. The requirement does not yet say whether a warning is expected, so I am reporting that as a usability concern for clarification. Mobile behavior remains outside this session's evidence.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The update replaces a broad verdict with observed paths and a specific open question.

Second-round challenge

A new clue consumes the final five minutes. Explain which original path was left unexamined rather than stretching the timebox into a full-coverage claim.

Language-check answers

1. C - desktop-only Correct. The case describes desktop exploration only.
2. B - expected behavior Correct. A defect verdict needs a defensible expectation.

05 · Conversations

1. Unsaved edits disappear without a warning - A fictional tester debriefs the twenty-minute interrupted-edit session.
2. A charter narrows exploration without scripting every step - Fictional testers agree a bounded session on interrupted searches.
3. An unexpected label becomes a focused inquiry - A fictional exploratory tester discusses a clue rather than merely continuing random actions.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Exploration finds an unclear keyboard path

A fictional desktop dialog can be closed with a pointer, but the tester has not found a keyboard route in a ten-minute exploration. Focus starts in the Search field. Tab cycles through Name, Save, and Search; Escape leaves the dialog open. Pointer Close works. The requirement asks for keyboard completion but does not specify exact keys. These observations describe this fictional dialog, not universal tool or platform behavior.

Role A: Tester: describe the attempted path and request the intended keyboard interaction.

Role B: Designer: acknowledge the required outcome and ask which focus position and actions were tried.

Possible opening: The pointer route works, but I haven't completed the required keyboard-only path from this focus position.

Success checks

- State the observed focus state and actions.
- Separate failure to find a route from a universal impossibility claim.
- Request a concrete intended interaction for follow-up.

Add a complication: A colleague says not finding a route proves none exists on every platform.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 08 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Giving a release-evidence handover

Hand over accurate test status and remaining uncertainty to the named decision owner.

CASE

A fictional candidate Q20 has ten planned checks: seven passed, one failed, and two blocked by unavailable sample data. The agreed exit criterion requires all critical-path checks executed and reviewed; one blocked check is critical. Mara owns the release decision, which has not been made.

Teach this move

Blocked is not passed or failed behavior: the intended check could not be completed. A pass percentage needs a clear denominator, and outstanding critical evidence matters even when most executed tests pass.

Vocabulary to check: test summary, residual risk, exit criterion, blocked test.

Model response

For Q20, seven checks passed, one failed, and two were blocked by unavailable sample data. One blocked check is on the critical path, so the stated execution-and-review criterion is not yet met. Mara, please take the failed result and blocked critical check into the release decision. The summary provides evidence; it does not itself approve release.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision gives the full result distribution and avoids inventing a release decision.

Second-round challenge

Someone reports seven passes out of eight executed checks and omits the two blocked checks. Explain both the executed denominator and the full planned scope.

Language-check answers

1. B - not evaluated Correct. Blocked execution leaves the intended behavior unevaluated.
2. A - blocked Correct. The blocked critical check prevents the required execution and review.

05 • Conversations

1. Seven passed, one failed, two blocked - A fictional tester hands Q20 evidence to release owner Mara.

2. Seven out of eight hides the planned scope - A fictional test lead clarifies a pass-rate statement before a release meeting.

3. Yesterday's evidence belongs to yesterday's candidate - A fictional tester qualifies a test summary after a new build arrives.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | An agreed exception needs a named decision

A fictional exit criterion requires a report-export check, but the sample generator is unavailable. The release owner may consider an exception after reviewing the risk; no exception has yet been granted.

Role A: Tester: state the blocked evidence and unmet criterion without making the exception decision.

Role B: Release owner: ask for the affected workflow and the missing evidence before reviewing the exception request.

Possible opening: The export check remains blocked, so the stated criterion is unmet; the exception request is still undecided.

Success checks

- Keep request and approval separate.
- Name the untested workflow and residual uncertainty.
- Confirm the release owner retains the decision.

Add a complication: A colleague says requesting an exception means it has already been accepted.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All products, builds, test data, results, and incidents are fictional English-language practice, not a testing certification course, security assessment, implementation manual, or release authorization. Quality assurance includes broader quality practices; these lessons focus on testing communication within those roles. Use the actual product contract, tools, evidence, qualified reviewers, and local decision responsibilities in real work. No specific platform behavior or universal defect-rating scheme is implied.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Software Developers, Quality Assurance Analysts, and Testers

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/computer-and-information-technology/software-developers.htm>

International Software Testing Qualifications Board: Certified Tester Foundation Level overview

<https://istqb.org/certifications/certified-tester-foundation-level-ctfl-v4-0/>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Guided message practice gives four choices with explained feedback. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Adapt a partner or class activity

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Software Quality Assurance and Testing English

Professional audience: Software quality assurance analysts, manual testers, test engineers, automation engineers, and test leads

Scope: All products, builds, test data, results, and incidents are fictional English-language practice, not a testing certification course, security assessment, implementation manual, or release authorization. Quality assurance includes broader quality practices; these lessons focus on testing communication within those roles. Use the actual product contract, tools, evidence, qualified reviewers, and local decision responsibilities in real work. No specific platform behavior or universal defect-rating scheme is implied.

Lesson 01: Agreeing the expected result

Original fictional case: A fictional booking feature says cancellations are allowed 'within 24 hours.' One example allows cancellation exactly 24 hours before the event; another rejects it. Time-zone handling is outside this exercise. The requirement owner can clarify the equality case.

Language workshop: Ask what makes the result correct

Communication goal: Resolve a missing expectation before assigning a test verdict.

Language guidance: A test oracle is the basis for judging the result, not necessarily another program. When wording and examples conflict, state the precise input whose outcome is uncertain and ask the responsible person to settle it.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): For input ___, source A expects ___ while source B expects ___. / Which source should govern the equality case? / The observed result is ___; the expected result is still ___.

Vocabulary: test oracle: A source or method used to determine whether an observed software result is acceptable or correct. / acceptance criterion: A specific condition that a feature or change must satisfy to be accepted by the relevant stakeholders. / expected result: The outcome a test is meant to check against

a stated requirement or other justified basis. / ambiguity: Wording or evidence that permits more than one plausible interpretation of intended behavior.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Requirement owner: agree, for this fictional exercise, that cancellation exactly twenty-four hours before the event is allowed; wording beyond that equality case still needs review.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: Someone says the current implementation should define correctness automatically. Explain why reproducing existing behavior does not settle conflicting requirements.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: The phrase within twenty-four hours leaves the boundary unclear, and the two examples disagree at exactly twenty-four hours before the event. Which outcome is intended at equality? I need an agreed acceptance criterion to judge that case. Until then, I can report the observed result, but I cannot assign a defensible pass or fail against these conflicting examples.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Adapt a supported occupational language lesson

1. Ask for learner support needs, group size and time. Offer two B2 learners and 20 minutes as a default and wait for confirmation.
2. Use the reference's real language goal, terms and case facts. Provide a timed plan containing reading, four-choice dialogue gaps, scaffolded speaking, focused feedback and a retry. No activity may require open-ended writing.
3. Give two separate speaking role cards with known facts, an objective, a possible opening, one question to resolve and three success checks. Put model responses in a separate teacher section. Label invented complications and preserve uncertainty.
4. Include four original gap-fill exchanges with four plausible options each and exactly one answer. Provide option-specific explanations separately. B1 support adds a word bank and frames; C1 stretch uses more nuanced choices and spoken follow-up, not essays. Include solo rehearsal of both roles.
5. Check facts, terminology, answer uniqueness and timing before presenting the plan. Finish with a four-choice exit question and an optional spoken retry. Do not certify proficiency or teach professional procedures.

END PROMPT

Adjust tone and register

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

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TASK: Match the wording to the listener

1. Quote one actual utterance from the reference. Identify its purpose, audience and degree of certainty. Offer a colleague, supervisor or outside customer as the new listener. Wait for my selection.
2. Supply four possible versions A-D and a specific constraint, such as explaining an unfamiliar abbreviation without changing a pending decision into approval. Make exactly one version satisfy all constraints. Wait for my choice.
3. Explain the strengths and limitations of every option. Treat valid stylistic alternatives as alternatives, not mistakes; rewrite an ambiguous question instead of rejecting reasonable English. Avoid national stereotypes.
4. Continue with three short, role-labelled exchanges in which I select the missing reply from four choices. Include a clarification and a disagreement. Wait after each item and invite a spoken rehearsal after feedback.
5. Finish with two complete model exchanges for different listeners. Identify what changed and what stayed the same. Do not assign open-ended writing.

END PROMPT